[14] Apparently, its actual name was the Bombay-Hedjaz Company but was known as the Shah Line Company, Blake, *B.I. Centenary*, p. 170.

[15] T&TD, p. 18. These are the words of K.R. Guruswami Aiyar, SSNCo's honorary legal adviser, when he met the governor of Madras, Sir Arthur Lawley on 1 April 1908, after the Tirunelveli 'riots'.

[16] Upendra Lal Roy Bahadur's oral evidence in *Indian Mercantile Marine Committee* (IMMC), evidence volume, p. 482. Also cited in Mehta, *Indian Shipping*, p. 37.

[17] The humiliations faced by the merchants are widely documented. See especially, *Swadesamitran*, 19-6-1906; T&TD, p. 18; the 1908 biography of VOC, Krishnasami Aiyer, *Sriman V.O. Chidambaram Pillai Jeeviya Charithira Churukkam*, p. 18. Also see Nellaiyappar, *Va.Oo. Chidambaram Pillai Charithiram*, p. 11. The humiliations are recorded as late as in 1925. See *Swadesamitran*, 26-3-1925 for the high-handed way in which the Madura and Company, BI's Tuticorin agents treated the local merchants.

[18] Oral evidence of S.D. Krishna Aiyangar, IMMC, evidence volume, p. 626.

[19] Annual report (1907–08) reproduced in MPAI, 1908, 1434(a).

[20] Oral evidence of S.D. Krishna Aiyangar, IMMC, evidence volume, p. 629. Also see *The Hindu*, 18-1-1924.

[21] *Sentamil Selvi*, 23(4), December 1948 published an editorial, penned by the poet Puthaneri Ra. Subramanian, as obituary.

[22] For instance, see *India*, 21-7-1906.

[23] VOC to unknown addressee, dated Tuticorin, 23-3-1906.

[24] SSNCo's annual report (1907–08), MPAI, 1908, 1434(a).

[25] VOC's letter dated Tuticorin, 23-3-1906. Addressee not known.

[26] In other documents, it is spelled as *Shah Allum*. Clearly, VOC was writing from memory.

[27] VOC's letter dated Tuticorin, 12-4-1906.

[28] *The Hindu*, 14-6-1906.

[29] While the Tamil transliteration of the steamers' names in the Tamil sources makes it difficult to identify them, the spellings in the English papers too are, regrettably, not consistent.